

knowledge. He has no “aperceptive mass” behind the reaction; the portfolio manager, quite simply, can remember the profit margins of a hundred companies, how the stocks react to a variety of situations, and where in the spectrum of managers he himself fits. If he knows these things, he can be away from the market and still know where its rhythm and his are meshing. In short, if you really know what’s going on, you don’t even have to know what’s going on to know what’s going on. All you need is a hell of an aperceptive mass, an IQ of 150, and a dollop of ESP, and you can ignore the headlines, because you anticipated them months ago.

There is one requirement that is absolute in money managing, and you have already learned it with the first Irregular Rule: If you don’t know who you are, this is an expensive place to find out. The requirement is emotional maturity.

“You have to use your emotions in a useful way,” says Dr. McArthur. “Your emotions must support the goal you’re after. You can’t have any conflict about what you’re after, and your emotional needs must be gratified by succeeding at what you’re doing. In short, you have to be able to handle any situation without losing your cool, or letting your emotions take over. You must operate without anxiety.”

---

*There is one requirement that is absolute in money managing . . . If you don't know who you are, this is an expensive place to find out.*

---

The psychological tests can’t really tell you whether you are going to be an ace at making money; they are descriptions of existing groups, some of them followed up with later tests for incumbency (how long in the job), contentment, and success. You may be out of the patterns and still succeed, or the world may change to the point where these are not the successful patterns. But given the world as it is, this is the way the Game goes. Some analysts should not manage